

The Industry Is Recalibrating

Key insights from IAPCO EDGE Stockholm 2026

THE SHIFT

Transactional service → **Trusted partnership**

IQ only → **IQ + EQ integration**

Being busy → **Being profitable**

NUMBERS THAT MATTER

96%

of client complaints are about
service, not work quality

93%

client retention when you become
the core PCO

67%

say venue costs are the biggest
budget pressure

THE HUMAN MOMENT

"Profitability becomes accidental *when you don't stop to decide what success looks like, what drives your profit, what behaviors to reward.*"

Nicky Mc Grane — Commercial Mindset Session

THREE THINGS TO DO DIFFERENTLY

01 Stop to measure before you move

Track project-level margins. Most PCOs don't know their exact profitability per event.

02 Listen to understand, not to reply

The biggest communication failure: formulating your response while the client is still talking.

03 Ring your clients on Friday

Ask "what's worrying you this weekend?" One call transforms a vendor into a partner.

KEY THEMES

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|  Human Connection
Relationships are the
ultimate differentiator |  Profitability
Measure what actually
drives margin |  Collaboration
Risk-sharing models are
the new advantage |  Innovation
Replace cynicism with
curiosity |
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